



BRAND BOOK V1.0
SPRING 2026

PennyLime.

A funding system built for the people who built the gig economy. Same job. New rules.

A book in 14 parts.

01 The Story

02 Mission & Values

03 Positioning

04 The Customer

05 Voice & Tone

06 The Logo System

07 Color

08 Typography

09 Iconography

10 Photography & Illustration

11 Motion Principles

12 UI System

13 Applications

14 Don'ts

Same job. New rules.

The bank was built for a world where you got paid every other Friday by the same employer for thirty years. That world is gone. Sixty million Americans now earn their living one ride, one delivery, one project at a time. But the financial system still asks for the W-2 it knows will never come.

PennyLime exists because someone had to design funding for the way work actually happens. Not "alternative" lending. Not a workaround. A funding system that reads bank deposits the same way an old loan officer read a pay stub, except faster, fairer, and on a phone.

We're not a bank. We're not a payday lender. We're not a generic merchant-cash-advance company chasing brick-and-mortar restaurants. We are a tech company building the receivables-purchase product the gig economy needed ten years ago.

73%

OF GIG WORKERS SAY
TRADITIONAL LENDING IS
INACCESSIBLE

60M

AMERICANS EARNING GIG
OR 1099 INCOME

48h

FROM APPLICATION TO
FUNDED

What we believe.

MISSION

Fund the people who fund the on-demand economy, on terms that respect what they actually earn.

VISION

A world where a Tuesday-night Uber driver can get capital to fix their car as fast as a Fortune 500 can issue a corporate bond, and at a fair price.

PROMISE

Your earnings are your credit. We never ask for a W-2. We disclose every cost in plain English before you accept. We say no when no is the right answer.

VALUES

Plain English

Factor rate. Daily remittance. Total cost. Spelled out before you tap accept. No fine print, no last-minute surprise fees.

Earnings > Credit

A 92-day deposit history is a better predictor than a FICO score for a 1099 worker. We underwrite reality, not paperwork.

Fast or it doesn't count

Money you need next week is a different product than money you need tomorrow. We optimize for now, because that's when it matters.

Decline kindly

If we can't fund you safely, we'll say so within minutes and explain why. Hope is not a product.

Tech, not theater

Plaid for income. Increase for ACH. Real APIs running real underwriting. Not a 1990s underwriter in a startup t-shirt.

Repayment is a relationship

We model hardship into the product. Slow week? Your remittance is a percentage, not a fixed bill. Reward repeat customers.

Where we sit.

PennyLime is a tech-first funding platform for the on-demand workforce. Our product is a merchant cash advance, but our positioning is a software company. We earn customer trust the way Stripe earned developer trust, with developer-grade transparency, predictable APIs, and a brand that signals competence.

POSITIONING STATEMENT

For self-employed gig workers and 1099 earners who can't get a fair shake from traditional lenders, PennyLime is the tech-driven funding partner that buys a piece of your future earnings at a transparent rate, deposits cash within 48 hours, and adapts when your week does. Unlike payday lenders, generic MCAs, or banks, we underwrite from real-time bank data and price for the actual risk of the income, not the absence of a W-2.

WE ARE

- A tech company that ships funding
- A receivables-purchase product (MCA)
- API-driven and audit-ready
- Fair, fast, transparent
- Built specifically for 1099 income

WE ARE NOT

- A bank or licensed lender
- A payday loan
- A generic MCA chasing restaurants
- A credit-score-driven product
- "Lending for the underbanked"

Who we build for.

Our customer is not a type of person. It's a type of work. The Uber driver in Tampa, the freelance designer in Brooklyn, the rover sitter in Phoenix, the Amazon Flex driver in Sacramento — they share an income pattern, not a demographic.

PRIMARY

The Working Operator

25-55 years old. Drives 30-60 hours a week across 1-3 platforms. Income \$2K-\$8K monthly. Owns a phone, a vehicle, sometimes a small fleet. Treats their gig as a serious business; tracks miles in an app, files a Schedule C. Needs \$500-\$5,000 advances for vehicle repair, equipment, or to bridge a slow week.

CHANNEL	Reddit communities, platform driver forums, TikTok
PAIN	Gets declined by banks; suspicious of payday lenders
TRIGGER	Truck breaks down, slow holiday week, child medical bill

SECONDARY

The Sole Proprietor

28-50. Freelance creative, consultant, or platform service provider (Fiverr, Upwork, TaskRabbit, Thumbtack). Variable monthly income, often LLC-organized. Wants \$2K-\$10K to bridge AR gaps, buy equipment, or fund a marketing push.

CHANNEL	Twitter, LinkedIn, freelancer Discords
PAIN	Income is "lumpy"; banks want 2 years of tax returns
TRIGGER	Big invoice 60 days out, software/tool needed today

WHAT THEY WANT FROM US

1.

A real number, fast.
Don't waste their
time.

2.

Respect for their
work. Stop asking
for a W-2.

3.

Fair pricing in plain
English. Show the
total cost.

4.

Flexibility when life
happens. Variable
remittance is the
gift.

Confident. Clear. Kind.

PennyLime sounds like a smart friend who happens to run a fintech. We tell the truth fast, in short sentences. We don't shout. We don't flatter. We don't hide behind disclaimers.

VOICE TRAITS

- Direct, never preachy
- Confident, never cocky
- Warm, never saccharine
- Smart, never clever
- Specific, never generic

WE SAY

- Fund / Funded / Funding
- Advance / Cash advance
- Verified earnings
- Plain factor rate
- Daily / weekly remittance

WE DON'T SAY

- Loan / Lending / Borrow
- APR / Interest
- "Easy money"
- "You qualify!" (without context)
- "For the underbanked"

VOICE IN PRACTICE

YES

"You're approved for \$3,000. Repaid as 7% of your daily Uber deposits, ~24 days at your average earnings. Total cost \$390. Tap accept to move."

NO

"Congratulations! You may qualify for our exclusive funding offer. APR varies. See terms. Get cash now!*"

YES

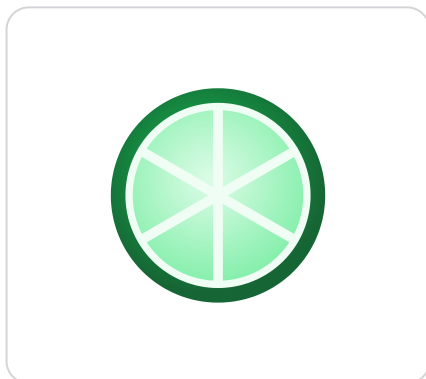
"We can't fund this one. Your last 30 days had three returned deposits. Try again in 60 days, or chat with us about what changed."

NO

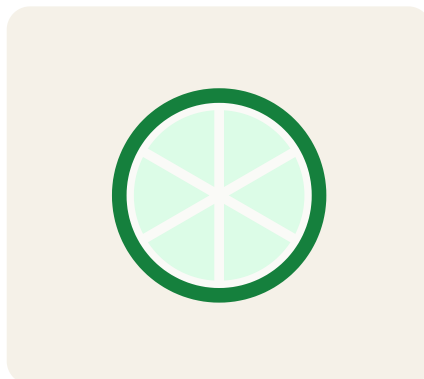
"Unfortunately, your application was unable to be approved at this time due to underwriting criteria."

A lime, sliced.

The PennyLime mark is a stylized cross-section of a lime: a green hemisphere divided by six radial spokes, with a center dot. It reads as a fruit, a coin, a compass, and a sun. Read whichever feels right — they all map to "energy, freshness, direction."



Primary · Full color on white



Knockout · Single color on paper



Inverse · Bright green on ink

Wordmark



Type set in display sans, weight 800. The "Lime" in green; the "Penny" in ink. No space between the two halves. Never set in all-caps.

Lockup

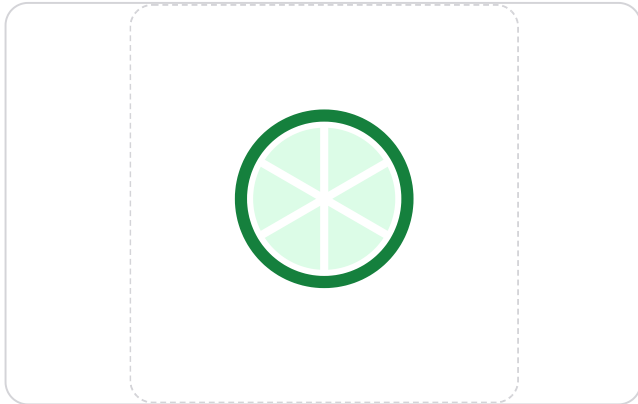


Mark and wordmark together. Mark height equals 1.2× cap height. Spacing between mark and wordmark equals half the cap height (the "x").

Clear space & sizing.

Clear space

Always reserve a margin equal to the height of the inner circle (the "x") on all sides of the mark. Nothing — type, image, edge — encroaches.



Minimum sizes

Mark must remain legible. Below these thresholds, use the simplified single-color version.

PRINT	14pt / 5mm height min
DIGITAL	24px height min
FAVICON	Single-color version only
EMBROIDERY	Single-color, simplified spokes

Don't

- Stretch, skew, rotate, or recolor
- Add drop shadows or outlines
- Place on busy photographs without an underlay
- Change the spoke count or center dot
- Substitute the wordmark font

A green that means yes.

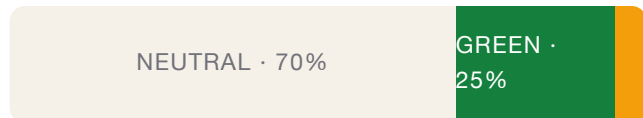
Lime green is the brand. Not a finance blue. Not a fintech violet. The color of go, of approval, of growth. Held against an ink-black or warm-paper neutral, it does the entire emotional job of the brand.

PRIMARY Lime Green HEX #15803D RGB 21, 128, 61 CMYK 84, 22, 99, 8 Pantone 348 C	ACCENT Bright Lime HEX #22C55E RGB 34, 197, 94 For highlights and illustrations only	DEPTH Forest HEX #166534 RGB 22, 101, 52 For hover states and pressed UI
TINT Mist HEX #DCFCE7 RGB 220, 252, 231 Card backgrounds, "approved" status pills	TINT Pale HEX #F0FDF4 RGB 240, 253, 244 Soft surfaces, success backgrounds	INK Ink HEX #0A0A0A For body type and primary surfaces
PAPER Warm Paper HEX #F5F1E8 Editorial backgrounds, print collateral	SEMANTIC Amber HEX #F59E0B Warning states, "needs attention"	SEMANTIC Red HEX #DC2626 Errors, declines, destructive actions

Ratios & rules.

Default ratio

In any composition, aim for roughly 70% neutral (paper or ink), 25% green family, and 5% accent or semantic color. Green is a finishing move, not the whole canvas.



Accessibility

All primary combinations meet or exceed WCAG AA. The brand never relies on color alone for status — pair with iconography or text.

GREEN / WHITE	5.1:1 · AA · use for buttons
GREEN / MIST	4.6:1 · AA · use for badges
INK / PAPER	17.4:1 · AAA · default body
BRIGHT / INK	8.5:1 · AAA · ink-bg headlines

Don'ts



Don't blend brand green with non-system colors.



Don't reduce opacity to fake a tint. Use Mist or Pale instead.



Don't use a yellow-shifted "lime" green from outside the system.

One sans, two weights, one mono.

PennyLime types are restrained on purpose. A single contemporary sans handles both display and body. A monospace partner handles numbers, code, and the small data details that signal we are a tech company.

PRIMARY

Inter

A modern grotesque sans. Used for everything except numerals in data contexts.
Weights deployed: 400 (body), 600 (UI emphasis), 700 (subheads), 800 (display).

MONO

\$3,000.00

Geist Mono. Used for currency, factor rates, transaction IDs, code, and any digit grid. Anywhere precision matters.

Display 800
120 / 110

Get funded.

Section 800
48 / 52

Same job. New rules.

Heading 700
22 / 28

Banks don't get gig work.

Subhead 600
16 / 22

Verified earnings, not credit scores.

Body 400
14 / 22

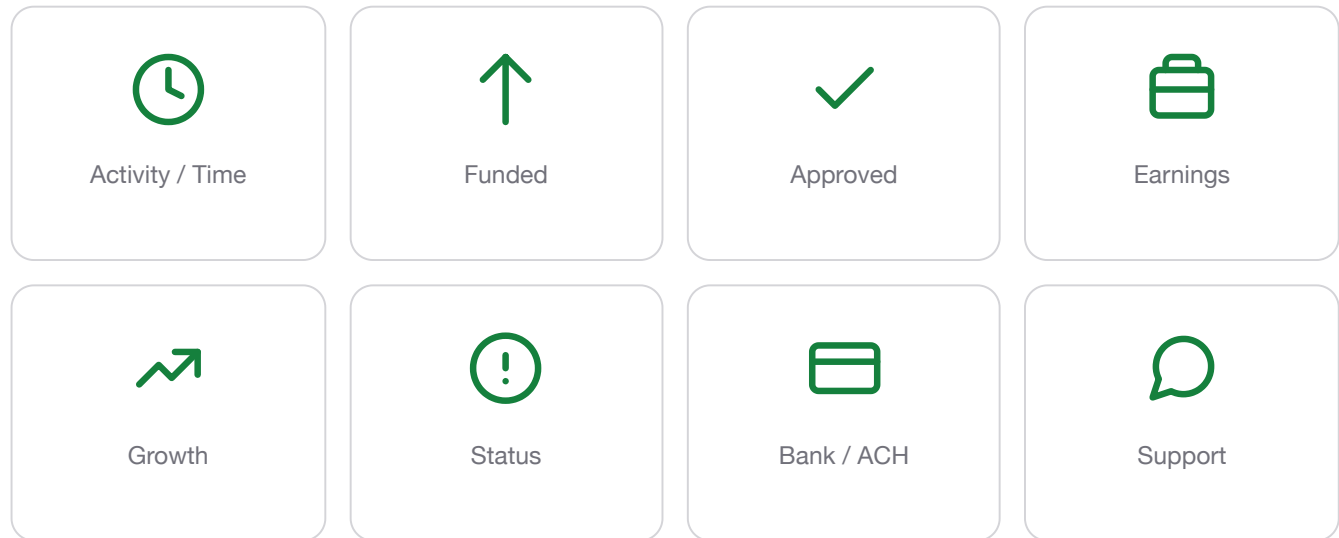
A merchant cash advance is the purchase of a portion of your future receivables at a discount, in exchange for a lump sum today. Not a loan. No APR. No interest. Just a transparent factor rate disclosed before you accept.

Mono 600
13 / 18

\$3,000 · 1.30 factor · 24 days · \$390 cost

Two-pixel rule.

Icons are drawn with a 2-pixel stroke, rounded caps, and rounded joins. No fills. No multi-color icons. They live in a 24-pixel grid and align to whole pixels at common UI sizes. The vibe is engineering, not illustration.



Source: Lucide icons (lucide.dev), MIT-licensed, customized to brand stroke and color. New icons inherit the same 24-grid, 2-pixel stroke, and round join geometry. Filled icons are reserved exclusively for the system status pills (success, warning, error).

Real people. Real machines.

PennyLime never uses smiling-stock-actor handshake photography. Our visual world is two layers: documentary photography of people working (delivery bags, dashboards, laptops, hands) and clean editorial illustration that shows the product itself in action.



Documentary, candid, available light.
Driver's seat at 6am, delivery bag on a sidewalk, the moment of a bank notification.

Photography · Documentary. Cool color cast. People working, never posing. Avoid handshakes, board rooms, white-toothed smiles.



Illustration · Editorial geometry. Receipts, app screens, simple objects on warm paper. Always says "money moving" or "decision made."

Illustration system rules

Geometry first

Compose from rectangles, circles, and 30°/60° angles. Hand-drawn squiggles are permitted as accent only.

Two-color limit

Brand green plus one neutral. Never a rainbow palette. Tints/shades of green are allowed.

Show the product

Phones, app screens, bank statements, receipts, dashboards. We illustrate the artifact of the transaction, not the handshake.

Confident, not hyperactive.

Movement signals technology and momentum, but never desperation. PennyLime motion is decisive: short durations, ease-out curves, no lingering bounces or attention-seeking loops.

DURATION

Standard transitions
220ms. Page changes
340ms. Status
confirmations **450ms** with
overshoot.

EASING

ease-out for entries.
ease-in for exits. Never
linear, never bouncy.

DIRECTION

Forward motion only on
success. Backward motion
reserved for errors and
reversals. Vertical for steps
in a flow; horizontal for
time.

Signature interactions

- **Approval moment:** The status ring fills counter-clockwise, then locks with a single soft pulse and a check icon.
- **Number reveal:** Currency values count from 0 to final on first paint over 600ms. They do not animate on subsequent loads.
- **Step progression:** Vertical scroll between steps. Each step's headline fades in on entry (220ms), supporting copy 80ms after.
- **Success disbursement:** A single particle of brand green travels from the bank icon to the user's account icon along a smooth path. One time, never looped.

Tokens & building blocks.

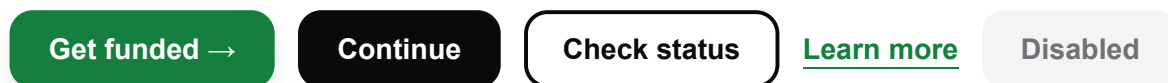
SURFACES

APP	#FAF77 warm paper
CARD	#FFFFFF · 1px border #E4E4E7
INVERSE	#0A0A0A ink
SUCCESS BG	#F0FDF4

RADIUS

PILL	999px
BUTTON	12px
CARD	16px
HERO	24px

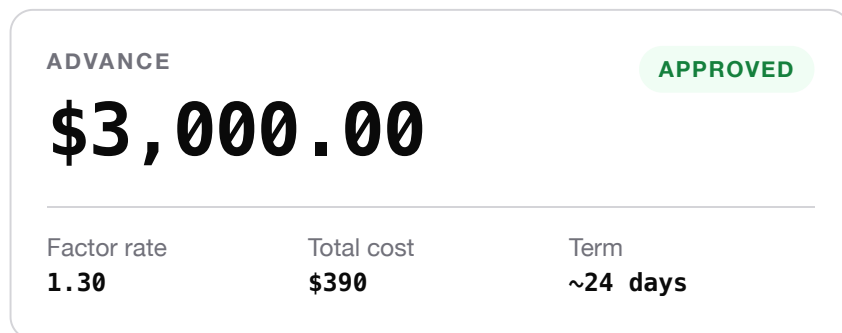
Buttons



Status pills



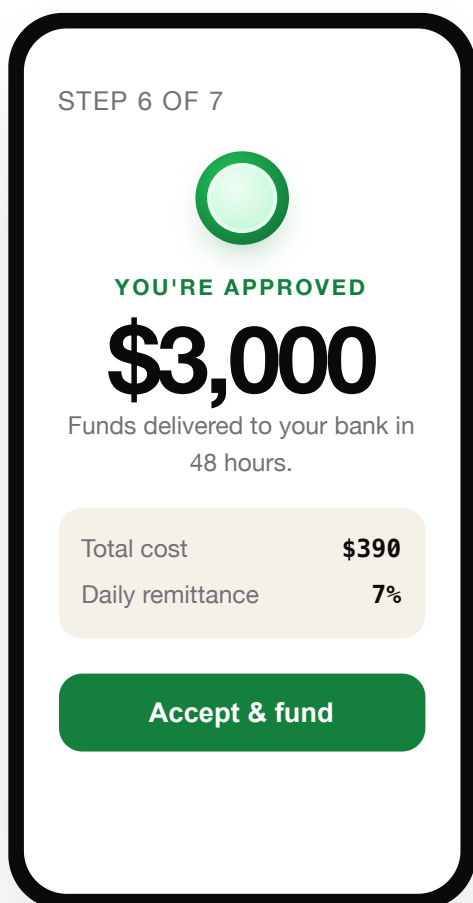
Card · advance summary



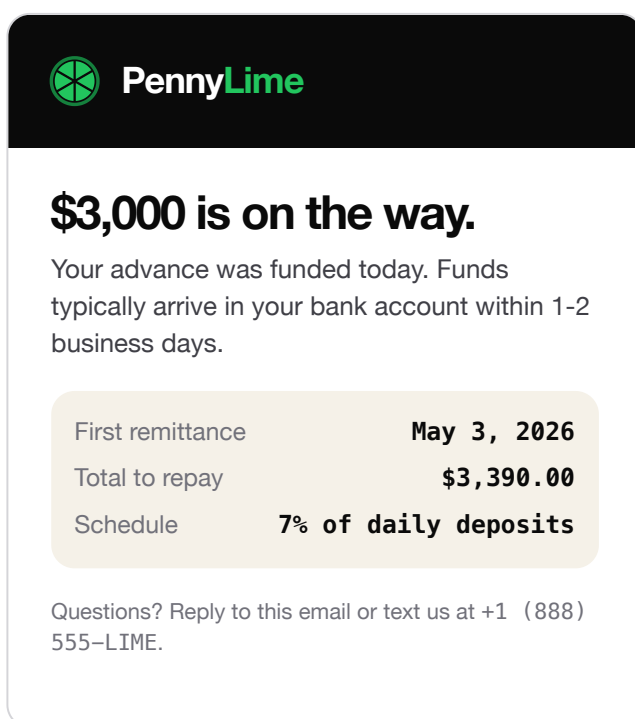
Where the brand lives.

The PennyLime brand operates across web, mobile, transactional email, social, and the rare physical surface (business card, swag, partner deck). Below, a sample application rendered in-system.

Mobile app — approved screen



Email — funded confirmation



If you do these, we are no longer us.

DON'T

Call the product a "loan"

It is a merchant cash advance, the purchase of future receivables. The legal distinction matters and the brand reinforces it everywhere.

DON'T

Use APR or interest-rate language

Cost is expressed as a factor rate. Quoting an APR triggers regulatory exposure and confuses the customer.

DON'T

Show stock photos of suits shaking hands

Our customers don't wear suits. Use documentary photography of actual gig work, or system-styled illustration.

DON'T

Use "easy money" or pity language

We don't sell desperation. Our copy treats the customer as a smart business owner facing a normal capital need.

DON'T

Replace the brand color with a market-trending palette

Lime green is unique in the MCA space. Drifting toward fintech blue or violet erodes the only visual moat we have.

DON'T

Hide the total cost

Total dollar cost is shown above the fold of every approval screen. No fine print, no asterisks. Transparency is the product.

When in doubt: simpler, clearer, less. Ask "would I trust this if I drove for Uber?" before shipping anything that says "PennyLime."

Same job. New rules.

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